3
THE VIRUS STRIKES

4 MARCH 2020

INDIA | 26 ACTIVE CASES | 0 DEATHS

WORLD | 43,611 ACTIVE CASES | 3,288 DEATHS

Reality struck India when 15 people from a group of Italian tourists tested positive for COVID-19 in New Delhi. A male tourist from the group after experiencing flu-like symptoms first tested positive in Jaipur. Following which, his wife, 14 others from the group as well as their driver tested positive.[1] The authorities got their first taste of COVID-19 management when all of the groups' contacts—the places they visited, the restaurants they dined at and the hotels they stayed at—needed to be traced, isolated and put under surveillance.

RD, who had returned from Italy via the Middle East with his brother, had hosted a birthday party for his son in New Delhi's Hyatt Hotel. Several kids from two neighbourhood schools attended this party.[2] Only the next day, when he began to show symptoms, he got tested and turned out positive. Both schools had to suspend classes immediately. The kids and their parents had to be closely monitored and the schools had to be sanitized. This gentleman also met with a bunch of people in Agra who had to be traced and tested. After contact tracing, it emerged that none of his primary contacts had tested positive except his brother, who had travelled with him. And by great good fortune, none of the children tested positive either.

Once again, Dr Nitish Gupta and his fearless team were on ground zero at Safdarjung Hospital treating these new cases. They too had children, parents and spouses to go home to. They too worried about carrying the